

Yaphet Gelan

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Education

Minnesota State University, Mankato Mankato, MN

Expected May 2028

Bachelor of Science in Computer Information Technology

Minor in Mathematics

Relevant Coursework: Intro to programming, Data Structures, Algorithms, Computer Architecture, Calculus 1, Calculus 2

Awards: Maverick's International Scholarship, Very Great Distinction

Organizations: ColorStack, NSBE, IEEE

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, C, HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Technologies: React, Next.js, Node.js, Express.js, Spring Boot, FastAPI, Tailwind CSS, REST APIs, SQLite, Supabase, Sanity CMS, Stripe, Docker, Vercel, Digital Ocean

AI & Developer Tools: Claude, Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, VS Code, IntelliJ IDEA, PyCharm, Android Studio, PyTest, Figma

Soft Skills: Leadership, Team Collaboration, Communication, Problem-Solving, Common Sense, Adaptability, persistence,

Experience

Founder & Lead Developer | Volunteer Web Development Initiative — Mankato, MN

June 2025 – Present

Next.js, React, Tailwind CSS, Sanity CMS, Stripe, Vercel, Claude, Cursor

- Launched a volunteer web development initiative after identifying 16+ local nonprofits and small businesses with outdated or nonexistent websites; created a client intake questionnaire to gather their requirements.
- Recruited and led a team of 4 fellow student developers, assigning responsibilities, managing project timelines, and serving as the primary point of contact between clients and the development team.
- Used Claude, Claude Code, Cursor and other AI-assisted development tools to accelerate front-end customization, debugging, and documentation while critically reviewing generated code and making all architecture and testing decisions ourselves.
- Built and deployed responsive, SEO-optimized websites using Next.js and Tailwind CSS, integrating Sanity CMS and Stripe and maintaining continuous deployment through Vercel.

Store Manager | Verizon — St. Peter, MN

May 2025 – January 2026

- Led daily coaching and performance tracking for sales representatives, increasing accessory attachment from 0.9 to 2.7 units per transaction.
- Raised device protection attachment from 22% to 55% by tracking rep performance and improving customer-focused sales conversations.
- Drove store revenue to 119% of monthly target and grew gross additions from 35 to 56 per month.

Projects

AudioGen | Python, FastAPI, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Supabase, OpenAI API

January 2024

- Developed an audiobook generator web application using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Utilized Supabase as a backend-as-a-service (BaaS) for user authentication, data storage, and management.
- Integrated external APIs, including OpenAI, for audio generation.
- Designed and implemented a RESTful API using FastAPI to manage communication between the front end and back end.

Guessnum | React, Node.js, Express.js, Socket.io, SQLite, Figma, Claude

February 2025 – May 2025

- Developed a real-time multiplayer number puzzle with daily challenges and tracked user statistics; launched to steady engagement averaging 50+ views per day at a 50% bounce rate.
- Built a responsive React UI with components for lobby, game board, and results; added client-side validation and keyboard accessibility.
- Exposed REST endpoints with Node.js and Express for game creation, leaderboard fetch, and daily challenge rotation; added rate limiting and input sanitization.

Toppers Route | Java, Android Studio, Google Maps API, Tesseract OCR

September 2024

- Designed an Android application to automate pizza delivery workflows by extracting customer addresses from receipt photos.
- Integrated Tesseract OCR with image preprocessing to improve text recognition, parsing street, city, and ZIP fields into structured address objects, then used Google Maps API and geo URI routing to launch turn-by-turn navigation.